least they had a television in there so I could watch the game. At the end of ninety minutes, they told me I could leave and I went and watched extra-time from the tunnel leading out to the field. I couldn't take in what was unfolding in front of me: it was as if the sending-off wiped away any other memories I might have of the game. But the moment David Batty missed his penalty, and the Argentinians went rushing towards their goalkeeper to celebrate, it sank in. *I'll be going home tomorrow*.

That night was the worst of my life but I did have one miraculous thing to hang onto: I'd soon be with Victoria, who was pregnant with our first child. The day the England party had arrived in Saint-Etienne ahead of the Argentina game, we'd got off the plane and there'd been a message on my cell phone.

'David. It's Victoria. Please call me as quick as you can.'

I'd got on the team bus and rang her back.

'I've got some news for you,' she said.

'What is it?'

'We're pregnant.'

I couldn't believe it. I wanted to stand up in my seat and scream it out to everybody. It was mad. I couldn't believe what I'd just been told. I went into the tiny toilet on the coach and just jumped up and down, hugging myself. I was so happy. It's the sort of news you want to share with people but, of course, I couldn't tell a soul.

There are particular things about that evening in Saint-Etienne that stand out clearly, as if they've been lit up by the flashbulbs that go off around a stadium at night: the sending-off itself, talking on the phone to Victoria, remembering I was going to be a father and, then, seeing my dad in the parking lot after the game. But the rest of it? Probably for my own sanity, it's a blur: the game's going on, but it's like I'm watching it through the wrong end of a telescope; the anger, the frustration and the shame; and the disbelief that this could all be happening to me.

When it was over, the England players went to the end where our supporters were massed. I didn't feel like I could be any part of that, so I turned and went back to the dressing room. At the time, Glenn Hoddle was doing the television interview in which he said that, if it had been eleven